Two stars and one small wish teacher and cover plan

BUILD Spring 1 Week 5 Monday 1 February 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Review and improve my piece.

Today: I can find two useful parts and choose one small change.

Success criteria

I can use a real piece of my own work.

I can give two stars with clear reasons.

I can choose and test one small wish.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For four pupils: four chosen real pieces from weeks two to four, or accurate sound/movement records; four books or arts logs and four pencils. Keep original work and any chosen trial together in four labelled spaces.

Provide the four picture-and-word prompts for each pupil, or display/read them aloud. The meaning must not depend on colour alone. Adult models are separate from pupil work.

Visual tests: eight small spare sheets, familiar drawing tools and materials actually needed by the chosen piece. Paint uses a small amount of familiar washable non-toxic paint, five brushes, four mats, two stable water pots, cloths and drying space if needed.

Fold-print tests use fresh small paper, three pea-sized dabs on one half, a clear fold/edge border, gentle pressing and flat drying. Do not force wet paint or glue onto a dry original print.

Sound or silent review needs a quiet seated space, a clear stop cue and actual sequence notes if available. Keep sound below talking volume. No recording device is required; pupils may direct an adult.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0 to 15 seconds: Show a real adult example. Say: I notice this work before I change it. My first star is one feature and why it helps.

15 to 30 seconds: Point to a second different feature. Say: My second star has its own reason. These are observations, not points or prizes.

30 to 45 seconds: Choose one small wish. Try it on spare paper or in a short silent rehearsal while keeping the original state. Say: I can actually do this action.

45 to 60 seconds: Compare the real test with the start. Say: I record what happened. I keep the original and choose one action for next time.

Arrival and starter

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Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: Choose your own real work from weeks 2 to 4. It can be paint, a print, sound or a silent piece. You can share with just an adult.

What to say: Find one piece you actually made, or the real note of your sound or silent sequence. Choose something from weeks two to four that you can review today. We look at choices in the work, not at how good a person is. There are no scores, rankings or competitions. A made-up feeling or abstract idea is enough. If work is missing, make a tiny honest fresh piece now and date it today before reviewing it.

What good looks like: The pupil chooses actual own work or makes a small dated fresh piece. The adult identifies the true medium and makes private sharing available without asking for personal disclosure.

Materials free fallback: Use a real witnessed movement note, or let the pupil direct a short silent sequence now. State honestly whether this is an earlier piece or a fresh one made today.

Check and response: A fresh piece is a valid honest starting point. It must not be labelled as missing work from an earlier week.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Look at the eye, two stars and tool pictures. The stars are useful parts in your work. The wish is one small change you can make.

What to say: Read each picture label aloud. The eye reminds us to look or listen. Star one and star two each name a different feature that helps the maker's idea. They are observations, not points or prizes. The tool reminds us to choose a wish we can act on, then check it. A star needs more than 'nice'. A wish needs more than 'make it better'.

What good looks like: The pupil can identify the purpose of the picture prompts and distinguish a specific feature from a score or vague praise.

Materials free fallback: Read the four labels and model them through a short silent sequence. The pupil may point to a picture, choose a spoken label or direct the adult.

Check and response: Useful star: 'The slow ending helps my calm idea.' Useful wish: 'Add a longer pause before the end.' Vague praise or a general judgement about the pupil is not a feature-based review.

Modelling and cover guidance

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I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Watch the adult review a real class model. Star 1 names one useful part. Star 2 names another. The wish names one small action. Watch a test on spare paper or in a short rehearsal.

What to say: Use an actual adult example, not a pupil's piece. For a calm sound model, star one is the gentle volume because it suits the idea; star two is the slow ending because it feels still to me. My wish is to add a longer pause before that ending. I perform the original, then rehearse the changed pause and note what really happened. For visual art, I might value a clear curve and an open space, then test wider spacing on a spare version. I keep the original state and label the test as a test. The model is not pupil evidence.

What good looks like: Two different features are linked to the maker's intention, followed by one achievable action and a real small test. Before and test states use the same art form and remain honestly identified.

Materials free fallback: Actually perform a short silent curve-and-pause sequence. Name two observed features, then try a longer pause in a second performance. The pupil can direct the adult's actions and compare them.

Check and response: Ask: 'Is my wish a small action I can do, or only a word like better?' Expected: a small action. If unclear, compare 'make it better' with 'add a pause before the end'.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Use one actual pupil piece or a truthful fresh small piece made today. Read the four picture-and-word prompts: look or listen, star one, star two, wish and change. Model two different feature-based stars and one small action. Let pupils test that action on spare work or in a same-form rehearsal, retaining the original before state. A dry fold print can have a new trial on fresh paper; do not force an alteration onto the original. For no materials, actually perform or direct a silent sequence and review a real changed rehearsal. Keep the actual medium, two stars, wish, test and next action in the log. Follow the seven-stage timing and final two Review minutes for tidy-up.

Guided practice and task

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We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Help review an adult class model. Choose two different useful features. Choose one wish that names a small action. Try it on a spare test or in a rehearsal.

What to say: Use the picture prompts in order. Ask what the maker intended, then accept two feature-based stars. Let pupils choose one small, feasible wish. Hinge: Which wish can we act on today: A 'be the best', or B 'make the pause before the ending longer'? We will test the action and record the true effect. Keep our class review separate from pupils' own evidence.

What good looks like: The pupil selects B, gives or confirms two distinct observed features, and directs a real test of one achievable change. No pupil is ranked against another.

Materials free fallback: Use a short adult silent sequence and the same four spoken or pictured prompts. The pupil directs one changed pause or size while keeping the rest of the sequence the same.

Check and response: B is specific and manageable. If A is chosen, model one small action and ask a parallel check: 'Which can I do: be perfect, or move these two marks farther apart on a spare test?' Continue when the pupil identifies a real action.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: In your book or arts log, use one real piece. Give star 1 and star 2. Point to each feature. Choose one small wish and say why. Test it on spare paper or in a short rehearsal. Keep the before state, test and your own words.

What to say: Start with what the piece is intended to show. Use the pictures and words to name two different helpful features, such as a clear mark and a gap, or a gentle volume and a pause. Choose one achievable wish linked to that intention. Keep the actual original state before testing. For a drawing or painting, use spare paper or a small copy for the test. For a dry fold print, do not force a change onto the original: make a small new trial on fresh paper with changed spacing, following the safe fold-print steps. For sound or movement, perform the real original sequence, then rehearse the one chosen change. Compare like forms. If the old form cannot be accessed, make a tiny fresh piece in the accessible form and review that honestly today. An adult may handle materials under the pupil's direction.

What good looks like: A review of actual own work has two feature-based stars, one doable wish and a real small test. The original remains available as the before state. The test has the same form as the work being reviewed; a new form is labelled as a fresh piece, not a false before-and-after improvement.

Materials free fallback: The pupil performs or directs a short silent sequence, uses two spoken or pictured stars, chooses one wish and actually rehearses that change. The adult records the real actions, pupil reasons and support when a recording method is available.

Check and response: Example only: Star one is a clear curve because it fits calm. Star two is the gap because it gives the curve space. My wish is a wider final gap. I test it on spare paper and say what changed. The pupil may choose a different justified feature.

Review and evidence

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Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Tell an adult your two stars and one wish. Show what your real test changed. Choose the one action for next time. Tidy and keep the original and test together.

What to say: Listen to the maker's reasons without diagnosing their feelings. Ask what the test actually changed and whether the action is still suitable for the intended piece. A test may need another small adjustment; keep that truth visible. No improvement is invented. Use the final two minutes to put tools away, leave wet trials flat and keep each original, test and log together. Sharing with just an adult is enough.

What good looks like: The pupil links the two stars and chosen wish to actual features, reports the real test result and selects a feasible next action. Work and records are safely stored.

Materials free fallback: An adult witnesses the before and test silent sequences and reads a short comparison back. The pupil confirms the action to use next time or chooses a smaller one.

Check and response: A useful review names a feature and its effect, such as a longer pause making the ending clearer to the maker. A test that did not help is recorded honestly and leads to a smaller achievable wish.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Arts log: Star 1 is ___ because ___. Star 2 is ___ because ___. My wish is to ___ to help ___. My real test showed ___.

What to say: Keep the actual date, piece or witnessed sequence, two stars, one wish and the real test result. Scribe exact words if needed, read them back and allow correction. State whether the piece came from an earlier week or was made fresh today. Retain the before state and the small test for lesson two. This is the pupil's review, not an adult score.

What good looks like: A dated entry records two specific strengths, one feasible action and the observed test. It refers to real own work and preserves an honest starting point for revision.

Materials free fallback: Take an oral or gestured review after the live test. The adult makes an accurate dated action note and retains the pupil's confirmed words when a recording method is available.

Check and response: Example only: Star one is a soft start because it suits calm. Star two is a clear ending because I know when it stops. My wish is to add a longer pause before the end. My real test showed the pause was easier to notice.

Access and teaching decisions

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Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the task and skill words aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

Stars are scores or a contest between pupils - Each star names a helpful feature in the maker's own work. There are no ratings, rankings or comparisons of personal worth.

A wish can just say make it better - Choose one small action linked to the intention, such as widening a gap or adding a pause. Try the action and record its real effect.

A dry fold print must be painted over to improve it - Keep the original. A new version on fresh paper can test a changed spacing. Retain both and label them as original and new trial.

Missing earlier work can be described as if it is here - Make a tiny honest fresh piece today, label the actual date and review it. Never invent work or observations from an earlier week.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.